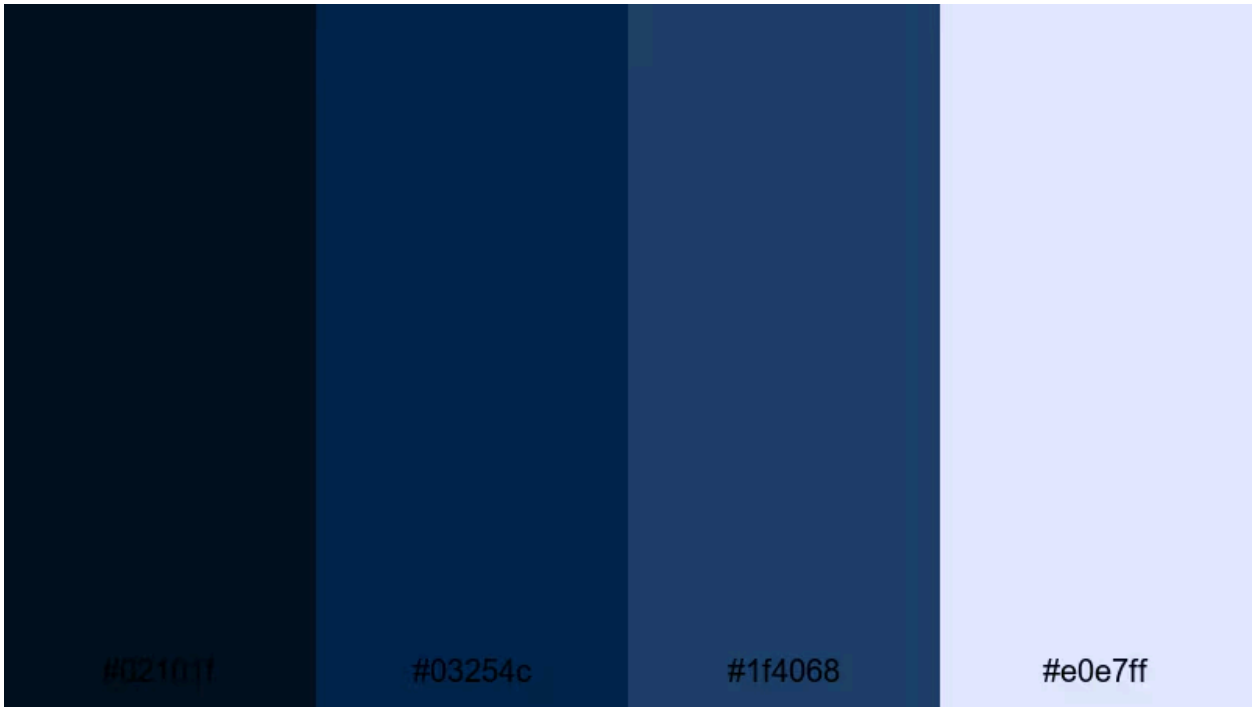
Color scheme: generally blue, navy



The middle two are preferred for the content- the background should be the lighter color

Few other color inspirations:





The menu/title/home screen:

- On the Top, large title: Quilted Languages [Tag line: How empires shaped the words of Romania and Japan]
- in the top right hand corner, 4 buttons for navigation - one to the home page, one to the “blog” section, one to the “credits” section, one to the “resources section”
- The buttons should rest upon a sort of shelf/bar that stretches across the top of the screen, a lighter blue
- The title should be below the top bar, slightly left of center.
- All space below the “bar” should be a kind of navy void, with a floating, idle globe below it.

By scrolling downward, one enters the main “content” section of the website

Content Design Strategy:

- Menu bar still the same as on home screen
- Preferably, when clicking on the “blog” button, the user should be taken to the section of the blog that corresponds to the section of the content that they were on - i.e. if they were viewing the “Romania 6th century” section, they should be forwarded to the “Romania 6th century section” of the blog, instead of the blog homepage.
- Rest of the page should be focused on visuals as described - globe should shift focus in line with each era/places needs, zooming in or out as the website scrolls up/down.
- “Mini text” as provided, non-blog info should be in smaller text boxes next to globe - preferably for romania with globe on left side and text boxes on the right, near to relevant visuals, and for japan with globe on the right side and text boxes on the left - refer to image
- The user should also have a little triangular button that allows them to move from the romania column to the japanese column and vice versa - japan should be on the right and romania on the left (east vs west, in a way)
- The transition between these two sections can be less smooth - would the most efficient just be a blur? Or would it be more efficient to just have it “slide” between the two sections.

“Blog”

- The menu bar should remain the same
- There should be a hamburger menu on the left, which can be opened up to reveal a scrollable menu to navigate through the different sections of the blog, which should be differentiated by headings - titled “Romanian in the year 500 - slavic migrations” and content the content from the provided blog writings.

- There should be an overall title, “Blog.” should be formulated like a google doc, where scrolling through the headings allows you to click on one and then jump to that part of the text.
- Citations should be shown at the end of each section, not at the end of all the writing

Credits

- Menu bar should remain the same
- Simple text down the middle detailing people who worked on the projects, as well as sources for visual and textual materials

Resources

- Menu bar should remain the same
- Dump of pdf materials for teaching and further education in a menu format with images and short descriptions below them

Overall Idea (Notes section)

You need to hook these people

Post visualizations spalttering onto page you can then request expperrt help! That owuld eb good. 1 hour packagope w/ crimson

Use canva to create visual references/ amoodboard
Visual elements or whatever is there something ismilar that can be used as a reference?

Logo and name are necessary

People dont read anymore so information needs to be VERY visual
Etc. etc.

Image timeline left to right like those world maps through time websites

Design doc

Wants a home page - map interaction, tabs, etc.

About me, why am i creating this.

Blog outside of site where people can read MORE about things

DESIGN & CONTENT

LINGUISTICS:

HISTORY:

Side by side

History & language

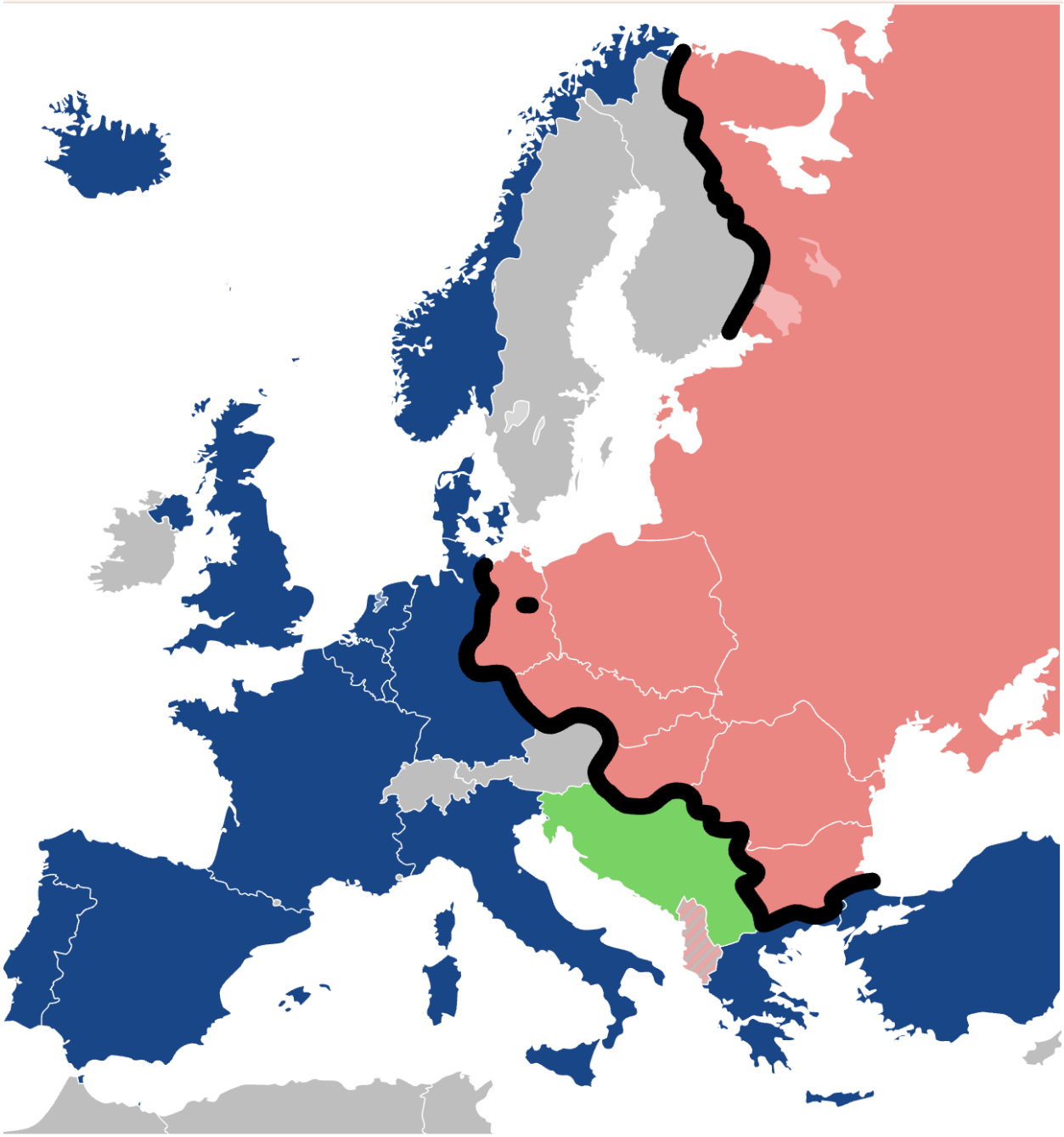
Try pendev

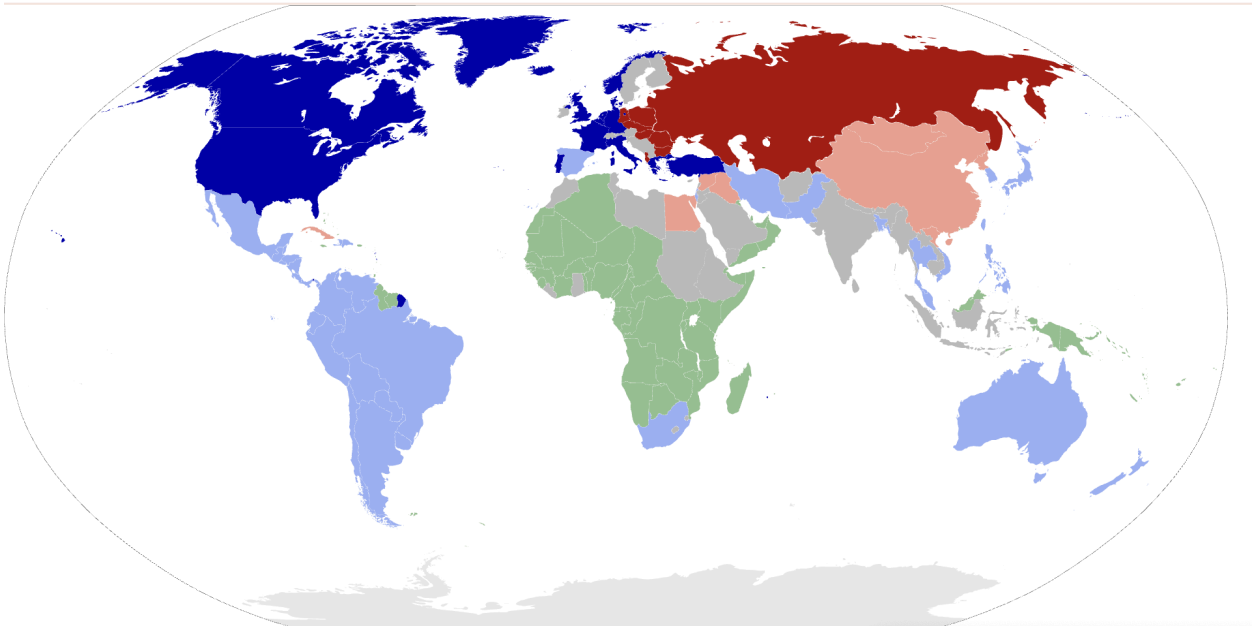
David McCandless

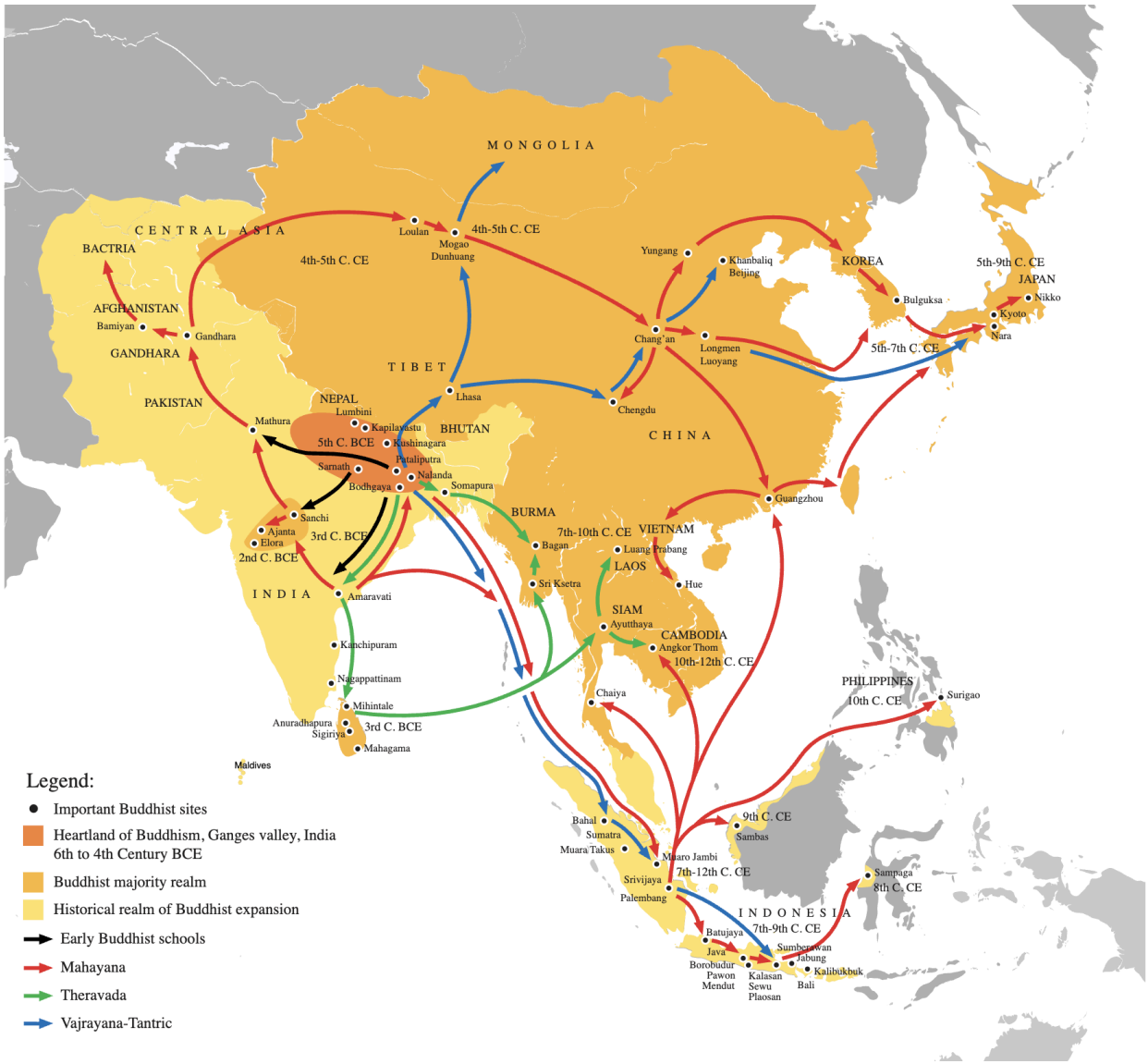
ROMANIA | JAPAN

Scroll ↑ ↓ through time · ← → or click to switch








MONGOLIA
CENTRAL ASIA
BACTRIA
4th-5th C. CE
Loulan
Mogao
Dunhuang
4th-5th C. CE
Yungang
Khanbaliq
Beijing
KOREA
5th-9th C. CE
JAPAN
Nikko
Bulguksa
Kyoto
Nara
AFGHANISTAN
Bamiyan
Gandhara
GANDHARA
Chang'an
Longmen
Luoyang
5th-7th C. CE
TIBET
PAKISTAN
Lhasa
Chengdu
NEPAL
Lumbini
Kapilavastu
BHUTAN
CHINA
Mathura
5th C. BCE
Kushinagara
Pataliputra
Sarnath
Nalanda
Bodhgaya
Somapura
Guangzhou
BURMA
Sanchi
Ajanta
Elora
3rd C. BCE
2nd C. BCE
7th-10th C. CE
Bagan
VIETNAM
Luang Prabang
LAOS
Hue
Sri Ksetra
INDIA
Amaravati
SIAM
Ayutthaya
CAMBODIA
Angkor Thom
10th-12th C. CE
Kanchipuram
Nagappattinam
Chaiya
PHILIPPINES
10th C. CE
Surigao
Mihintale
Anuradhapura
Sigiriya
3rd C. BCE
Mahagama
Maldives
Bahal
Sumatra
Muara Takus
9th C. CE
Sambas
Muaro Jambi
7th-12th C. CE
Srivijaya
Palembang
Sampaga
8th C. CE
INDONESIA
7th-9th C. CE
Batujaya
Java
Borobudur
Pawon
Mendut
Sumberawan
Jabung
Kalasan
Sewu
Plaosan
Kalibukbuk
Bali
Legend:
Important Buddhist sites
Heartland of Buddhism, Ganges valley, India
6th to 4th Century BCE
Buddhist majority realm
Historical realm of Buddhist expansion
Early Buddhist schools
Mahayana
Theravada
Vajrayana-Tantric

Language as Palimpsest

How empires shaped the words of Japan and Romania



Scroll ↑ ↓ through time · ← → or click to switch

Pre-history

Word: Frate

Romania

Frate - the word frate, meaning brother, is a very clear direct descendent of the word fratus in Latin, the language which formed the base of the romanian language. Just like in most other languages, Words describing familial relations often were retained by their descendents.

Further examples:

Soră - sister
Tată - father
Mamă - mother
Fiu - son
Fiică - daughter

Japan

弟 - the word for little brother, “Otouto” derives from a combination of two older japanese words, Oto and hito, meaning a young person. This word shifted in pronunciation and meaning over millienia, but is a poster child of the phenomena of familial relation words being retained from mother tongues

兄 (ani) - older brother
妹 (imouto “imo” + “hito”) - little sister
姉(ane) - older sister
父(chichi) - father
母(haha) - mother

500s CE

Romania

Iubire

This Romanian word for love has origins in the south slavic languages, from which romanian borrowed extensively over the course of centuries of cross-cultural communication and experience. The south slavs first migrated to south eastern europe around the 6th century, and from there spread throughout the balkan mountain range, bringing with them their unique language. Old church Slavonic specifically served as the liturgical language in the principalities of Moldavia and Wallachia for many years and marked Romanian permanently with their influence.

Other examples of words borrowed from old church slavonic:

Dragoste - love, endearment
Prieten - friend
Nevastă - wife
Sfânt - saint
Slavă - glory, hail

Japan

愛(ai)

The word for love most commonly used today in Japan has its origins in medieval china where the middle chinese word for love first made its leap onto the Japanese archipelago through the extensive literature of the chinese intelligentsia and religions, especially buddhism. Buddhism made its splash in Japan in the 6th century when it was endorsed by prince Shotoku Taishi. It's original usage in buddhist texts describing attachment and desire has shifted over time.

Other examples of early buddhist borrowings:

人間 (ningen) - human being. Interestingly, the readings "nin" and "gen" are no longer used for these characters outside of this context

愛情 (aijou) - love

友情(yuujou) - friendship

1400s CE

Romania

Chiftea - meatball. This word was borrowed from Ottoman Turkish, which itself borrowed the word from persian. It's a pretty easy example to understand - much of modern Romanian cuisine was formed and cemented under Ottoman and Greek rule. Ciorba, Musaca, pilaf, all common foods in Romania today continue to use the words that the Ottomans first brought to the principalities of Wallachia and Moldova. Food words are common borrowings, and often reflect the culinary neighborhoods of their countries of origin.

Pilaf - pilaf
Ciorbă - soup
Musacă - moussaca
cafea - coffee
Cioban - shepherd

Japan

1600s CE

Romania

Romanians lived, for hundreds of years, at the crossroads of multiple empires. While Ottoman, slavic, and Byzantine influence dominated the southern and eastern principalities of Wallachia and Moldova, the Transylvanian principality, which also had many Romanians, existed as part of a vast Hungarina Kingdom for many years, introducing many words from yet another non-romance language into Romanian. The word for city, Oras, comes from the hungarian varos, which itself comes from var, the hungarian word for castle. Political, historical and linguistic relationships helped to form the diversity of the Romanian language today.

Other examples:

- Gand - thought
- Gazdă - host
- Cheltui - to spend (money)
- Fel - type, sort

Japan

By the 1600s, Japan had started opening up to the world, albeit very slowly, and only to very specific groups, and only in very specific ports. So maybe they weren't really opening up. Nevertheless, portugues and dutch made a mark on Japanese through their early loanwords in the fields of science, industry, and western imports to the medieval tokugawa shogunate. かるた (karuta) was once the portuguese word for cards (cartas) and now refers to one specific card game in Japan, after centuries of shifting meanings.

パン (pan) - bread, from the portuguese pao
タバコ (tabako) - cigarettes, from the portuguese
ゴム (gomu) - rubber, from the dutch gom
ランドセル (randoseru) - a traditional japanese hard backpack - from the dutch.
ビー玉 (bīdama) - marble, a half-portuguese (vidro, glass) and half japanese 玉 (tama, ball) word that shows the way linguistic barriers are really only half as real as we make them out to be.

1850s CE

1950s CE

2000s CE